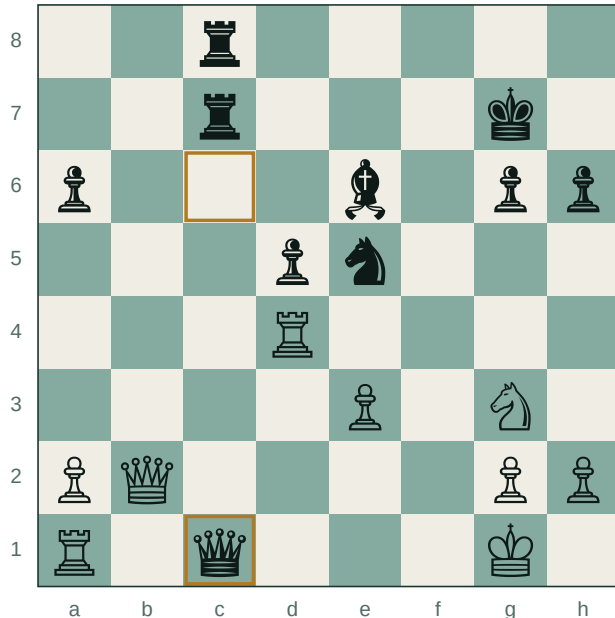


Active defensive resources: White, move 33

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 32...Qc1+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Rxc1 Rxc1+ 34. Nf1

33.Rxc1 The rook captures the queen on c1. Recorded reply: **33...Rxc1+**.

34.Nf1 The knight moves from g3 to f1.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -3 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e6 and knight on e5. Check for tactical protection.